

Benzocaine



What is it?

Benzocaine is an anesthetic (numbing medication). It is found in both prescription and nonprescription medications. It is used to reduce or relieve pain. It exists in the form of gels, ointments, drops, lozenges, solutions, aerosols, and sprays. It is often used to prepare the skin or a mucosal site such as the mouth for injection.

Based on their chemical structure, anesthetics belong to one of two classes – ester or amide. Cross reactions are more likely to occur within each family. It is important to understand which family of anesthetics you are sensitive to. Benzocaine is in the ester family of anesthetics.

BENZOCAINE can also be known as:

- P-Aminobenzoic acid ethyl ester
- Americaine
- Ethoform
- Ethyl aminobenzoate

Some Possible Uses of BENZOCAINE / Where it might be found:

- Burn and sunburn remedy
- Hemorrhoid treatment (i.e. creams, suppositories, enemas)
- Creams for anal itch
- Products used to soothe teething, mouth ulcers, canker sores, and denture irritation
- Anti-bacterial wash
- First aid spray
- Sore throat spray, cough drops, and lozenges
- Astringents and analgesics
- Products used for athlete's foot, corns, calluses, and warts
- Desensitizing Topicals

Other products that can cross-react with BENZOCAINE:

If you are allergic to benzocaine, you may need to avoid the entire ester aesthetic group. This may include:

- Topicals
 - Butacaine
 - Butesin picrate
 - Tetracaine
 - Cocaine (used in surgery)
- Ophthalmic (Eye) agents
 - Benoxinate
 - Tetracaine
 - Proparacaine (Alcaine)
- Injectables
 - Procaine (Novocaine)
 - Chloroprocaine
 - Tetracaine
 - Amylocaine (Stovaine)

Cross reactions to ester anesthetics do not always perfectly stay within the ester group. If you have an anesthetic allergy, it is best to get tested for all anesthetics that you might need to use, so that you can be sure which anesthetic is safe for you to use.

Rarely, a cross sensitivity may occur to other para amino compounds, such as:

- Paraphenylenediamine (in hair dye)
- Disperse or azo textile dyes
- Para-aminobenzoic acid (PABA) family of sun screens
- 4,4-diaminodiphenylmethane (i.e. in plastic eye glass frames)
- Thiurams (in rubber products)
- Even more rarely, hydrochlorothiazide or medications with sulfa

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What should I do to avoid BENZOCAINE?

In general, do not use benzocaine or ester anesthetics. Please see the CAMP app for a list of products that do not contain ester anesthetics.

Tell your medical provider, dentist, nurse, masseuse, aesthetician, pharmacist, vet, and others that you are allergic to benzocaine and may need to avoid ester anesthetics.

What is okay to use?

People with any type of anesthetic sensitivity can usually use:

- Pramoxine
- Diphenhydramine
- Dyclonine
- Saline injections

These amide anesthetics may be ok to use:

- Lidocaine (a.k.a Xylocaine)
- Bupivacaine
- Dibucaine
- Etidocaine
- Prilocaine
- Mepivacaine
- Pyrrocaine

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

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